what has happened has happened to me

Cinderia

RENJ

Lycidus · Sequins and Crowds · Growing Under ·
Electric Silvers · Next Ages' Gauge · Junction · Show the Molars ·
Scattered Innards · Disjoint · No One Knew · A Red Window ·
Man of the River · Futile, I Know

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Foreword

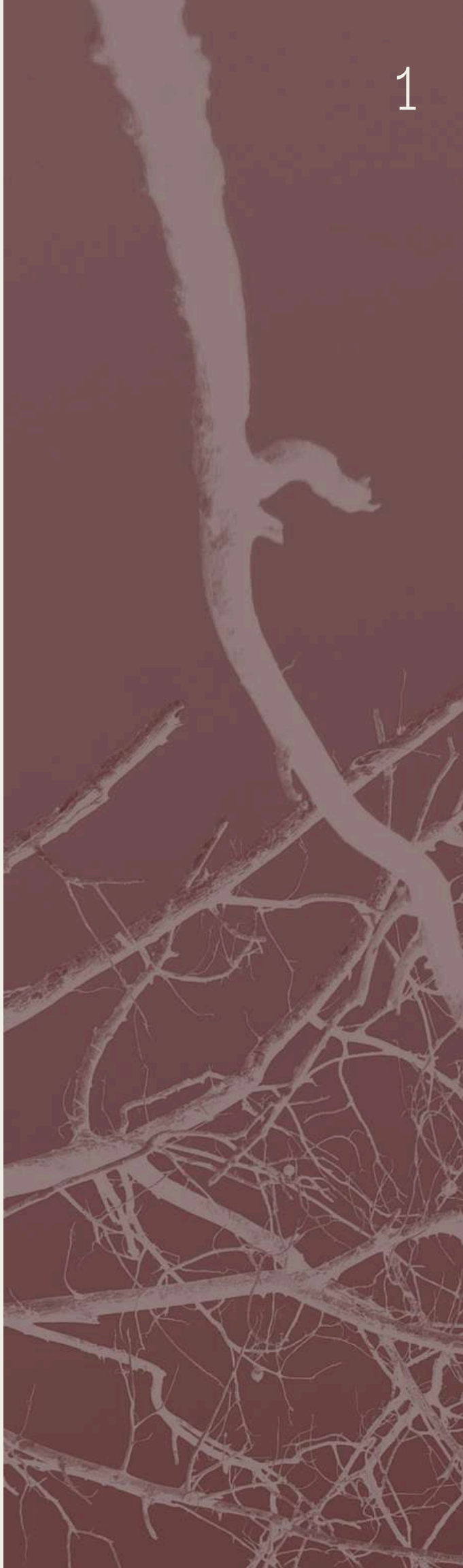
To have this collection is to witness an emulsification—the deliberate, agonizing process of taking the raw elements of a human soul and refining them until they form a stable, glittering, and ultimately artificial persona.

Cinderia documents the arc of a man who traded his natural flow for the static, heavy gold of fame. He chose the sequins, the electric silvers, and the "cookbook essential" life, believing that to be "well-bred" was the same as being well-lived. He played the game of mutual deception so perfectly that he eventually became the swindled.

But every performance requires a closing act.

This collection archives the residual inventory of a life where the Star finally realizes that the prize of public adoration was not worth the cost of his own existence. He is the man who looked out of his "red window" and finally decided to let the sand pass through his hands.

As you read, remember the only truth that remains when the performance fades: **"what has happened has happened to me."** You are about to turn the pages of a mysterious collection. Decide what to take from it—for like the Star, you are finally free to walk away.



I. Lycidus

RENJ

The haze summoned a whole crowd of believers.
Diamonds and sparkles, wonder and luster–
A set of hope, dreams, the good and the bad.
None of this has ever touched my soul, not even close.
A man on the tip of everyone's lips, a cookbook essential,
Legends cluster to see the young, the quintessential.
Everyone wants to brush their fingers on my hair,
Everyone wants to touch a piece of my flair.
A rhythmic array of shutters that create a syllabus,
All for a new billboard of a man named Lycidus.

And their favorite songs are eclipsed by my worst ones.
Coveted gold that the antiques had died for, yet failed.
An easy pull for such a hard man to decipher,
But diamonds are hard, aren't they? Easy to remember!
I am someone you'll meet without my presence;
I am at your dinner table even in times of a famine.
I graze my gaze and reap the fields of a bountiful harvest,
And in the extensions of my name, they scuffle to invest.
The detractors cry on the street, screaming: a scoundrel, a bogus!
And yet I am on a terrace announcing everyone call me Lycidus.

A maiden bed untouched by my skin was blessed–
One that I have slept in for six thousand nine hundred forty days.
At present, the cotton pulls out and cries itself,
But it must feel blessed to touch me every day when I slept.
My sweat has become a commodity; I have won everything.
A mansion, a studio, a concert, a theater, every starling.
An army for a name that was conjured up in a bathroom.
A name so loud, in fact, that the rhythmic shutters have stopped.
A display so bright that the haze stopped dusting,
And on the horizon is a son of Lycidus coming.

II. Sequins and Crowds

RENJ

Sequins wrapped my eyes as I stare inside the door,
Sequins stare back like a chant screamed by the crowd.
Crowds at my fingertips, a smile beyond a dream of luxury;
Crowds flock up to see the latest of my inventions–
Inventions of pure fury, false poetry, and deadly supplements;
Inventions of beauty, silver, gold, and diamonds.
Diamonds that eclipse the shine of the nefarious,
Diamonds that got stolen by this unassuming angel–
Angel of my dreams, angel of my screams; I build my bed from cash,
Angel of my tears and beauty hanging from my ears.
Ears that hear the chimes of the wind and see among the cons,
Ears that dare touch the moments in between performances;
Performances that trickled the crowd and pulled their pockets,
Performances that declare surprises among the shocked ones.
Ones who cannot see, cannot feel, cannot touch,
Ones who can give their castles in exchange for a haystack–
Haystacks devoid of any needle, yet sharp as an axe;
Haystacks that ate my time, burned by memory, under blankets.
Blankets that host a pair of the most trusted scoundrels,
Blankets that wrap two people who will never change.
Change is what we give them incompletely;
Change to which those pearl-clutchers will mind no business.
Business built by the verity of mutual deception,
Business held by some array of dangerous games;
Games played by two people who will always pay it backward,
Games played by mythical people who are now absent.
Absent will be the thought that the two of us existed,
Absent will be the moments that we had ladies swindled.
Existence is but a memory; memories fade by old, and so shall we;
Swindlers cross their eyes, forever unknown, forever undecipherable.

III. Growing Under

RENJ

Grace has always been a staple at the table.
For a man born in a stove, a city is to civilize himself.
"Eyes would tell a lot of stories," the negotiator said,
Traversed the golden fields on foot atop every pebble,
Trading my horse for a dream to be a frame on a shelf;
For a dream to be read as someone well-bred.

"Situations are far from ideal," the landlord said,
As I arranged my neatly folded clothes on the floor,
Hearing honks and cameras outside the alleyway.
A dying day and a birthing dream come from greed,
To be the man of the welcome sign everyone pictures,
But to dream is a man's form of giving leeway.

The window is large, and so is the view of the streets.
Everyone is looking down, weary of their steps.
"The bus leaves in five minutes," the conductor says,
As I try public transport as if I'm on a fleet.
Some are on their own; those with others close their lips,
And I tighten my hold on my wide, empty purse.

"Everybody's got to dream," the man argues on the streets,
As I walk past them and wait for stoplights.
I accustom myself to the view I have longed for;
My name will be parodied and criticized in the adverts.
An effective star doesn't shy away from the lights—
A dream I chased and somewhat got a hold of.

My clothes are tightly packed and in zippers.
"They have been thoroughly cleaned," the note said,
As I look around and a wider window opens with the wind.
I'm a dreamer looking down, hearing the sound of clappers.
A tabletop has presented itself to me, and now I'm well-bred,
And the spoon shows the best version of me I have ever been.

"I'm forwarding the call to you, mister," my assistant said.
I pick up my phone and turn to look at the window.
The wide window appears to be tighter every other day;
Kids stare at supercuts of my latest reels I flicked.
A father, a son, a billionaire, a conman, a widow—
I emulsify myself to a wide spectrum, yet I feel surveyed.

"Here goes the horse," the negotiator arrives at my home.
I look at the brown hair and beautiful hooves,
And I look at my soles with the marks of the pebbles.
I look at a window, and now it's just a peephole.
A look at my clothes, and now, they're just fabric.
This place is just too small even for a single horse.

IV. Electric Silvers

Hair that streaks of pulsating electric silvers.
Shoulders breathing breadth with the waters.
Kneecaps bleeding, a scarlet damnation with the mud;
Hands up high that the wind strikes blunt.

A sealed bottle floating with the whirlpool,
All shades of blue filled with shades of coal.
Skin covered in iridescent volatility;
One lucky guess of electricity derives flammability.

Fingertips with indentations of figureheads,
The webbing of the palms filled with copper beads.
The splashes are eclipsed by the volume of the clatter;
Eyes all through focused on the flipping of the matter.

What could a human mind ask himself to be transcendent?
What could a man ask for to be more than transient?
Remember me, oh remember me.

Unscrewing the hinges of the door to open it;
No keys will hold the weight of the hand's limit.
Fade into black, fade behind the curtain, all questions.
Enamel on the floor, a table filled with broken wishbones.

A departmentalized view of a kitchen and a nightmare:
Bay leaves, cinnamons, ribbons, and burned questionnaires.
An embroidered leaf, a perforated chair foam;
All for a paper wrapped in plastic, buried in loam.

All festivities, pyros and hydros, Western and Eastern.
The sand by the sea turning to stardust of yearn.
Blow the wind, eyelashes and leftover birthday candles;
Blotting ink, red clothes, charms, talismans, holy cradles.

What could a human mind ask himself to be transcendent?
What could a man ask for to be more than transient?
Remember me, oh remember me.

V. Next Ages' Gauge

Tasteless and odorless, unknown yet famous.
A bottle of wine or arsenic, no one knows anything.
Should I drink? Should I spill? Forever ignoramus.
Clink clink, blink blink, throw this shot into feelings—
Sneaky and unbothered, but it is never nameless;
Shall I chug it up and trust tomorrow to the ceilings?

Take it or leave it, put the hemlock on my pendant.
Crush it, fill it, take it for a crowd that wants more;
Everything is a tightrope, everything is redundant.
Cross the streets without looking, be with it forevermore.
Take it or leave it, today is just a moment to lament;
Be the charts the only ones keeping score.

Take these seeds and plant them all over my balcony;
Let it grow roses, carnations, or bella-donnas.
Take the best of me, throw into chances, let it be free,
Or at least an illusion of it among prima donnas.
No one is ever truly their own; the silver screen decrees
That at most, there is only one king among all faunas.

The paper edges of this mysterious book are unknown to man;
Show it to everyone, read it, and recite every page.
Was poison on the edges? I don't know—take what you can.
I take everything to calm down my crowd's losing rage.
Keep it or leave it, publish and see, stay or run;
Be on the shelves and be on the next ages' gauge.

VI. Junction

RENJ

Lines of white cover the junctions of wonder,
Those who cross paths once with the others,
Gazes that only exist less than a minute,
Limited by the rests of the vehicles beside it.

But some gazes wonder more than others,
A red dress brushing my brown leather,
Identifying the dues of the time between rests,
A wonder most of humanity come to obsess.

Vulnerable eyes cross the astute windows,
That show how I've wept like widows.
Lands beyond the concrete of the road,
Idealized by thoughts I overload.

Tomorrow, I'll be down this street again,
With the pollute of the mind, dirtiest of chagrin,
I'd stare by the countdown to start the pause,
To try and fill the blank after my "because."

For a mere thirty seconds, a soul is removed,
A cotton hem when the pause is on the move.
What could it be? A fleet of sighs, perhaps?
Or a happenstance I want to be a routine afast?

VII. Show the Molars

RENJ

I've been meaning to tell you of a throb within me,
A comeback of sorts, a belonging in the strange.
Oh, these chains in my journal let me go free—
Warm hands in the cold in these new phases of change.

Black bangs and curly browns crossing ties;
The tides are the limit, the jewels are now in colors.
A streak in the sky spelling names of the enticed—
Two pairs of lips, opening to show the molars.

Switching handwritings and papers of choice,
A long dark road to take with a torched voice.
Find me, oh find me—you'll be my reflection in the mirror;
I've never been this ecstatic to find such an error.

May this always stay, may this always be,
For once, grandeur is one for the dusty shelves.
Build a mansion atop those accumulated debris,
Be forgotten, be with the manifestation of my pleas.

May mortality be the only end for which this has,
And let that futility be filled with rows of peonies.
Be those ones that have wilted off veils and tuxes;
Let the closure be when the second coffin comes to seize.

Switching days and dishes to serve,
A long red carpet to take, a long celebration to make.
My skin, my bones, your tears, your nerves—
Find me, oh find me, in your reflection of what you bake.

VIII. Scattered Innards

RENJ

I reach a summit overpowered by pain,
A lone hiker, a lone fate to engrain.
My hair brushing against the air's.
My pulse trying to catch with the air's.

A singleton in place of utter cold,
Trying to wrap it warm yet chase to fold.
Oh, to be human and chase pieces;
To break is efficiency, but whole is centerpiece.

Deconstruct memories to build new ones.
Lone flyers take the longest to soar.
The lights are out, the feathers stay white,
Chasing familiarity in the stretch of flight.

Eyes will look upon the scattered innards;
I'd rather break mid-flight than be a scrutinized bard.
I am dying. But in death, life gets a new one.
I am living. But in life, death gets a new one.

Nothing matters, and as such everything must.
And so I open my arms like a mast.
Close my eyes and chase the rhythm of the air,
And leap forward to find my own share.

IX. Disjoint

RENJ

I draw in a place in my mind,
Every time I'm under light.
Was it a sin to have touched skin?
From the outside, it was not right.

I lived with cages around, hunting me,
Letting me choose which one to settle in.
I cloaked myself, yet I was scrutinized
For a young, unmapped sense of affinity.

But all had ended before I could begin;
They had parted ways long before I entered.
I build myself a road from my own stones,
Yet I was an outsider of the path I ushered.

I will always be the other side, the other man.
All I did was like someone, yet I almost died.
None of my stories blotted another's parchment;
I wrote mine when his had already dried.

I kept my thighs to myself, even 'til now;
No pearls to clutch, for your enamels have eaten them.
High horses, low grudges trust me somehow;
Even in my darkest pitches, I stand out to them.

Yet, I'll give it flowers as it should:
Fame or notoriety, a speeder, the other party.
I know for myself that I am not, I never could,
But in either way, in either else, that is my verity.

X. No One Knew

RENJ

Which fortuneteller could have seen
Six cognac eyes entangled on some scene?
Up in the roof: skin and bones, pastries and burns.
Deep in the skin: thumps and hums, kisses and urns.
And oh, no one knew the faith I had in your palms,
And oh, no one knew the distrust I have of your land.

Another is outside the room; better rest thy sighs.
We were so up high that time just took its flights.
A stone grew up to push into our house,
A twig snapped so your branches could sneak me aroused.
And oh, no one knew my palm could fit one more hand,
And oh, no one knew a sin like this could be grand.

Drunk in the haze of hazelnuts, looking down,
Up in the skies where whispers of suspense frown.
Calling from the other room, hidden in a basement,
Calling from a counter, sneaking off the warehouse shipment.
And oh, no one knew the living chase the breath of death,
And oh, no one knew the flames would reach the water's breadth.

The ball on my neck spins as the Earth is to the Sun,
Yet the star touches it while hiding from a galaxy shunned.
Magnificence in such a lowly, stable orbit of existence;
Oh, blame a wondrous mind for wandering for inconsistence.
And oh, no one knew these eyes are devoured by someone else,
And oh, no one knew these sighs have been caught for Valse.

Chasing off impermanence inside a room we built,
But oh, the window shows the tangling branches in winter wilt.
I sneak my hands out and wipe off the snow;
Cognac pairs grab my hair, and my hand is on another.
And oh, no one knew the crib would stifle itself thin,
And oh, no one knew these days would come to an end.

XI. A Red Window

RENJ

Beneath the sun, the salt moves with the tides.
A homecoming of sorts; the stones are moved.
Eyes view new patterns of ripples and crashes;
The sand touches new skin as the water collides.
The eyes feel no emotion other than being stoked–
Spine that valleys sweat, the kind I mix with ashes.

I open my lids with a red window of my soul;
A harsh light, an irritant of sorts.
My skin slips off my own calcium perforations,
My thoughts gutted out to a misery's cohort.

Beneath the sun, the clouds cast over my skin;
My browns turn to darker shades of caffeine.
The steel bar is as cold as my path barefoot is,
Sitting down on damp, thin clothes absorbing brine.
A reflection in the smooth steel starts to grin;
I look back and see a tortured kind of win.

I open my lids with a red window of my soul;
A tragic case of holding bare and holding on.
Salt flows hand in hand with the rivers on my cheeks.
Lifting my hand to cover and let the sand pass through.

The grin turned soft and the clouds came to an end.
My feet crash another one of the waves.
My arms fit into the valley of another's spine.
Borrowed time and a borrowed existence unfold then;
Four feet covered with salt, sand, water, graves–
It has long been buried, dead, and offered to the divine.

My lids are already red, so they don't need opening.
I lift my right hand and touch the air,
My left touching the cheeks filled with another's stream.
Long gone will be two souls trapped in an open sea.

XII. Man of the River

RENJ

I am a man of the river; we all are.
Steps of choice, circumstances flow, a scar.
And for all the grudges we hold for,
Exist for people no longer with the before.

But what can man do from his own humanity?
A tiny teacup can hold the hottest of tea,
A soft bread can crumble into bitter crumbs,
A whisper can be louder than a foray of drums.

Although forgiveness is a man's virtue,
It's a hard rock the river struggles to adieu.
What has happened has happened to me,
But no rush can remove a slow agony.

I open my arms, and I am a changed person,
One who has made another outstretch beyond.
But it's one of mundane alteration;
I may have changed, but I am an etched reputation.

My nights have been fields of lost cause,
Mourning for a contention I have long lost.
The path the river takes can only flow forward,
But one can chase its way fast and onward.

And for I am a man of the river, of fervor.
In a chase of a lost time leads to a present tremor.
For chasing the waters that had once touched me,
Has led to the troubled depth of the sea.

XIII. Futile, I Know

RENJ

I booked the ferry to traverse the strait of unknown;
I could have taken the bridge, but I want to feel low.
Take me on a trip that reflects the stars on the sea,
Eyes that glue to what kind of sparkle it could have been.

I take my chances every time I see a budding wave;
I touch and take a bottle to capture the tide's weave.
Futile, I know. But so were the moments I could never live;
Take me apart, take me where it goes to sieve.

A story I had always been able to light up, but tonight
It is as dark as an army winning their own fight.
Lonely for a fact that they've done what is right,
And now their purpose is to be with the dim light.

The cognac is now gone into my system; it is not rage,
Not grief, not loneliness, just an empty page.
Why leave me above the mountains? Why leave this age?
To be high on it is to be the lowest rank in the siege.

Did I just dodge a bullet or lose a vow to the wind?
Was to chase a heart the same as Judas has sinned?
Why can't one touch another from the same field?
Oh, take me back and let my cries be freed.

If I come back home to the other side of the strait,
Can I declare a truce to time and start it straight?
If I had known, I would have changed gold for crates;
It could have been a lifetime forever entangled fates.

Holy and true was a dream for a wondrous dreamer,
But broken and blue is a future for a fatal gleamer.
Take me tomorrow, a tomorrow that is yesterday;
Give me a day, change my prophecy, change me eager.

Fulfill my void, fulfill my windows, fulfill my eyes;
For a lifetime of commitment is the price for a prize.
Take me to finally belong, and take me to an arrest;
Take me home already, take me on, let me finally rest.

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